Learning Roadmap

Mini-CA + CFO + Family Office: a 12-month plan for building the business/finance quarterback

> **Objective.** Not to become a traditional practising CA, but to become the person who understands a client's entire financial operating system, diagnoses problems, coordinates specialists, and eventually runs the firm and its technology. CA/CS/legal partners handle work you are not licensed to perform yourself.

The roadmap has five pillars: Accounting, Tax & Compliance, Government Documentation, Fundability & Funding, and Finance/Virtual CFO. For the target market (SMEs plus HNIs such as actors, athletes, doctors and senior tech professionals), a sixth layer is added: **Personal/Promoter Finance & Wealth Structure**. The first six months are intensely practical.

1. The Full Syllabus: 70 Modules

● Critical ● High

#	Module	What You Need to Learn	Depth	Priority
A. Accounting & Financial Control				
1	**Accounting Fundamentals**	Debit/credit, journal, ledger, trial balance, accruals, provisions, depreciation	Strong	● Critical
2	**Bookkeeping**	Purchase, sales, expenses, receivables, payables, inventory, advances	Strong	● Critical
3	**Bank Reconciliation**	Bank reconciliation, unreconciled items, payment matching	Strong	● Critical
4	**Month-End Closing**	Closing checklist, provisions, depreciation, outstanding items, reconciliations	Strong	● Critical
5	**Financial Statements**	P&L, Balance Sheet, Cash Flow Statement	Strong	● Critical
6	**Financial Statement Analysis**	Margins, ROCE, ROE, liquidity, leverage, working capital	Strong	● Critical
7	**MIS**	Monthly management reports, dashboards, variance analysis	Strong	● Critical
8	**Payroll Accounting**	Salary structure, payroll entries, deductions, employee reimbursements	Working	● High
9	**Tally / Accounting Software**	Tally + one cloud accounting platform	Hands-on	● Critical
B. Indian Tax & Compliance				
10	**GST Fundamentals**	Registration, GST structure, ITC, invoices, returns, reconciliations	Strong	● Critical
11	**GST Operations**	GSTR-1, GSTR-3B, 2B reconciliation, notices, e-invoicing/e-way bill concepts	Hands-on	● Critical
12	**TDS**	Sections, deductions, deposits, returns, certificates, reconciliation	Strong	● Critical
13	**Income Tax Fundamentals**	Heads of income, deductions, computation, advance tax, returns	Strong conceptual	● Critical
14	**Business Taxation**	Proprietorship, partnership, LLP, company taxation concepts	Strong conceptual	● Critical
15	**Capital Gains**	Equity, mutual funds, property and other investment transactions	Strong	● Critical

#	Module	What You Need to Learn	Depth	Priority
16	**Tax Planning**	Legitimate tax planning vs tax avoidance/evasion	Strong conceptual	● Critical
17	**Corporate Compliance**	Companies/LLPs, annual filings, director-related basics	Working	● High
18	**Notices & Assessments**	Notice types, response workflow and escalation to CA	Working	● High
C. Government Documentation				
19	**Business Registrations**	PAN, TAN, GST, Shops & Establishment, Udyam etc.	Hands-on	● Critical
20	**MCA/ROC**	Incorporation, annual compliance, changes, basic filings	Working	● High
21	**Licences**	Common business licences and renewal cycles	Working	● High
22	**Government Portals**	GST, Income Tax, MCA and relevant state portals	Hands-on	● Critical
23	**DSC/e-Sign**	Digital signatures, authorisations, filing workflows	Hands-on	● High
24	**Compliance Calendar**	Client-wise recurring compliance calendars	Strong	● Critical
D. Fundability & Funding				
25	**Credit Analysis**	What banks/NBFCs actually look at	Strong	● Critical
26	**Financial Health**	DSCR, current ratio, leverage, EBITDA, cash flow, banking behaviour	Strong	● Critical
27	**Creditworthiness**	CIBIL/credit history, repayment behaviour, banking conduct	Working	● Critical
28	**Fundability Score**	Build your own 0–100 framework	Strong	● Critical
29	**Funding Documentation**	CMA/projected financials, business profile, projections, statements	Strong	● Critical
30	**Business Loans**	Term loan, WC limits, OD/CC, LAP etc.	Strong conceptual	● Critical
31	**Alternative Funding**	NBFC, invoice finance, equipment finance, venture debt	Working	● High
32	**Equity Funding**	Angel/VC/private capital basics	Working	● High
33	**Government Schemes**	Major SME financing/support schemes	Working	● High
34	**Funding Coordination**	Assess → Prepare → Match → Coordinate	Strong	● Critical
E. Finance / Virtual CFO				
35	**Cash Flow Management**	Operating, investing and financing cash flows	Strong	● Critical
36	**Working Capital**	Receivables, inventory, payables, cash conversion cycle	Strong	● Critical
37	**Budgeting**	Annual budget and departmental/business-unit budgets	Strong	● Critical
38	**Forecasting**	Rolling forecasts and scenario analysis	Strong	● Critical
39	**Financial Modelling**	3-statement model, assumptions, scenarios	Strong	● Critical
40	**FP&A**	Plan → Actual → Variance → Explanation → Action	Strong	● Critical
41	**Unit Economics**	Revenue, contribution, CAC, margins, break-even	Strong	● Critical
42	**Business Valuation**	DCF, multiples, enterprise value, equity value	Working	● High
43	**Virtual CFO**	Monthly CFO review, decision support, dashboards	Strong	● Critical
F. HNI / Promoter Finance				
44	**Personal Tax Architecture**	Salary, professional income, capital gains, investments, deductions	Strong conceptual	● Critical

#	Module	What You Need to Learn	Depth	Priority
45	**Professional Income**	Actors, doctors, athletes, consultants, tech professionals	Strong	● Critical
46	**Asset Structuring**	Individual vs company/LLP/trust concepts	Conceptual	● High
47	**Investment Reporting**	Equity, MF, bonds, property, ESOPs, foreign assets	Working	● Critical
48	**ESOP/RSU Basics**	Tax and reporting concepts for senior tech clients	Working	● High
49	**Succession Planning**	Nomination, wills, trusts, inheritance basics	Conceptual	● High
50	**Family Office Concepts**	Consolidated net worth, cash flow, tax, investments, reporting	Strong	● Critical
G. Client Management				
51	**Client Onboarding**	KYC, information collection, document checklist	Hands-on	● Critical
52	**Financial Health Check**	Diagnose a business in 60–90 minutes	Strong	● Critical
53	**Client Communication**	Explain finance/tax in plain English	Strong	● Critical
54	**Pricing**	Retainer, project fee, package pricing, value pricing	Strong	● Critical
55	**Proposal & SOW**	Scope, exclusions, deliverables, timelines	Hands-on	● Critical
56	**Client Review Meeting**	Monthly/quarterly financial review	Hands-on	● Critical
H. Firm Operations				
57	**SOP Design**	Convert every recurring service into SOPs	Strong	● Critical
58	**Quality Control**	Maker → Checker → Manager → CA/CS/Legal review	Strong	● Critical
59	**Document Management**	Client folders, permissions, version control	Hands-on	● Critical
60	**CRM & Workflow**	Leads → onboarding → delivery → billing → renewal	Working	● Critical
61	**Automation**	APIs, workflow automation, AI-assisted accounting/compliance	Working	● Critical
62	**Data Security**	Client financial data, access control, confidentiality	Strong	● Critical
63	**Regulatory Boundaries**	What you can do yourself vs what requires CA/CS/legal professionals	Very strong	● Critical
I. Business Building				
64	**Sales**	Lead generation, discovery calls, diagnosis-based selling	Strong	● Critical
65	**B2B Sales**	SME owner conversations and decision-making	Strong	● Critical
66	**HNI Acquisition**	Referral, network, reputation and relationship-based acquisition	Strong	● Critical
67	**Partner Network**	CA, CS, lawyers, lenders, insurance, wealth managers	Strong	● Critical
68	**Cross-Selling**	Accounting → compliance → CFO → funding	Strong	● Critical
69	**Unit Economics**	Revenue/client, gross margin, delivery cost, retention	Strong	● Critical
70	**Firm Scaling**	Hiring, utilisation, delegation, management layers	Strong	● Critical

2. Don't Study All 70 Equally

Your role evolves, and your learning should evolve with it:

> **Learner → Practitioner → Financial Controller → CFO → Firm Builder → Platform Owner**

Phase 0 — Months 0–3

"I should be able to understand a client's entire financial picture."

Area	Target	Area	Target
Accounting	★★★★★	**Working Capital**	★★★★★
GST	★★★★★	**Government portals**	★★★★☆
TDS	★★★★☆	**Financial modelling**	★★★☆☆
Income Tax	★★★★☆	**Funding**	★★★☆☆
Financial Statements	★★★★★	**HNI finance**	★★☆☆☆
Cash Flow	★★★★★	**Sales**	★★☆☆☆

Covers bookkeeping, Tally, Excel, financial statements, bank reconciliation, payroll, GST, TDS, Income Tax, MCA/ROC, government portals, financial-health metrics, lending basics, cash flow, working capital and modelling. **Don't wait until you "finish studying" to start — build dummy client files while learning.**

Months 3–6 — Become Client-Ready

Take 5–10 real or pilot clients. Time split:

70% Real client work	**20%** Structured learning	**10%** Business building

For every client, force yourself to produce this chain. This is how you start thinking like a CFO rather than a bookkeeper:

1	Books
2	Compliance status
3	Financial statements
4	MIS
5	Cash-flow picture
6	Financial-health score
7	Funding readiness
8	Recommendations

Months 6–12 — Your Real Specialisation

The firm shouldn't ultimately sell *"Accounting + GST filing."* It should sell:

> *"We become the finance function of your business."*

Focus	Progression
FP&A	Budgeting → Forecasting → Variance → Scenario planning
Virtual CFO	Monthly financial review → Decision support → Capital allocation
Fundability	Financial health → Gap analysis → Improvement → Funding package
Management Information	Dashboard → KPIs → Trends → Exceptions → Actions
Business Advisory	"What should the owner do next?"

3. The HNI Vertical — Separate Syllabus

An actor, athlete, doctor or tech executive doesn't necessarily need traditional accounting. They need a **Personal CFO / Family Office Lite** — potentially a strong second business line.

Module	What you should understand
Income architecture	Salary, professional income, business income
Tax	Income tax + capital gains
Investments	Equity, MF, bonds, property
ESOP/RSU	Especially tech executives
Cash management	Liquidity planning
Net worth	Consolidated personal balance sheet
Debt	Loans, interest, repayment
Insurance	Protection architecture
Asset ownership	Individual/entity/trust concepts
Estate planning	Will, nomination, succession concepts
Family finances	Spouse/parents/dependents
Major purchases	House, property, vehicles, businesses
Financial reporting	Monthly/quarterly personal dashboard
Tax calendar	Advance tax, returns, investments
Professional network	CA + lawyer + wealth manager + banker

The eventual product: **Personal CFO + Tax Coordinator + Family Finance Office**, rather than simply “accounting services.”

4. The Most Important Skill: Financial Diagnosis

Make this your #1 examination. Give yourself a fictional company with **₹25 Cr revenue** and its full data set — P&L, balance sheet, cash flow, GST data, TDS data, bank statements, receivables, payables, loans, inventory and tax history. Then ask:

> *“Tell me what is wrong with this business.”*

You should be able to identify:

- Why profit isn't becoming cash
- Whether working capital is excessive
- Whether debt is sustainable
- Whether GST reconciliation has issues
- Whether receivables are dangerous
- Whether margins are deteriorating
- Whether the company can raise ₹5 Cr
- What needs fixing before approaching a lender
- What management should do next month

5. Your Phase-0 Graduation Test

Take a hypothetical SME and independently produce a **Client Financial Health Report**:

1	**Business Snapshot** — Revenue | EBITDA | PAT | Debt | Cash | Receivables | Payables
2	**Compliance Health** — GST | TDS | Income Tax | ROC
3	**Financial Health** — Profitability | Liquidity | Leverage | Working Capital
4	**Cash Flow** — Operating CF | Investing CF | Financing CF
5	**Fundability Score** — X / 100
6	**Gap Report** — ● Critical ● Needs improvement ● Ready
7	**90-Day Improvement Plan**
8	**Funding Requirement**
9	**Funding Package**
10	**CFO Recommendations**

This builds directly on the roadmap's 0–100 Fundability Score, Gap Report and improvement path, followed by the funding network of banks, NBFCs, investors and other financing sources.

6. The Final Skill Stack — 10 Capabilities

Capability	Your target
Accounting	Understand and interrogate books
Tax	Understand the system and identify issues
Compliance	Know what needs to happen and when
Financial Analysis	Read the health of a business
Cash Flow	Understand where money actually goes
Fundability	Know why a business can/cannot raise money
CFO	Help owners make better financial decisions
HNI Finance	Coordinate personal/family financial affairs
Client Management	Convert complexity into a simple monthly service
Firm Building	Turn knowledge into SOPs + people + technology

By Phase 3, your personal focus moves away from individual transactions toward corporate/strategic finance, automation/AI, leadership, sales and the partner ecosystem.

One Important Distinction

You don't need to personally become the expert who signs or executes every regulated professional service. You need to become the person who can say:

> *"I understand the problem, I know what needs to be done, I know who should do it, I can review whether it was done correctly, and I can translate the result into a business decision for my client."*

That is the outsourced CFO / finance-partner mindset this education is built around.